

I built all of this for my own business before I offered it to anyone

This year I started a video business in Conyers from nothing. The company, the website, the Google listing, a phone system that answers when I cannot, and the videos themselves. Everything in here is something I did for myself first.

Why that is the part worth telling you

When I tell you how long the Google listing takes to verify, or that the texting side of a business phone needs carrier approval before it will send anything, I am not repeating something I read. I am telling you what happened to me, including the parts that went wrong and how long they took to fix.

You do not need all four of these. Most businesses need one or two, and the rest can wait a year. Part of the first conversation is me telling you which ones you can skip.

Video	Short videos of you doing what you already do, shot and cut by me, ready to post.
A website	Built for your business specifically, owned by your business, fast on a phone.
Your Google listing	The panel people see when they search you, set up properly and verified.
A phone that answers	Miss a call and the caller gets a text back in seconds. They reply, you answer later.

Video

I come to your place, film what you already do, put you on camera for a few questions, and cut it into something people will actually watch.

No script, no actors, no crew standing around, and no day of staged shots. You keep working the whole time I am there. You end up on camera because nobody explains your business the way you do, and I ask the questions the way a customer would.

What you get. Vertical versions for Instagram, TikTok and Facebook, horizontal for your website and your Google listing, captions already written for you, and every file named so you know what it is.

Two ways to do it. One video that introduces the business, or a monthly visit that keeps new ones coming without you having to think of ideas. Flat prices, written down at isaiahsmithfilms.com/local.

The files are yours. Forever, with no logins to hand over and nothing to renew.

Straight with you. This is the thing on the list I have done longest. Sixteen years in film and television, most of it in Los Angeles, on shows for Netflix, FX, Disney and Freeform, and I am in the Motion Picture Editors Guild. My first real video job, sixteen years ago, was driving out to local businesses and doing exactly this.

A website

A site built for your business specifically, not a template with your logo dropped into it.

The colours, the type and the layout come out of your actual place and your actual work. If the design could be lifted onto another business without anyone noticing, I have done it wrong, and I will throw it out and start again rather than hand you that.

What you get. A site that loads fast on a phone, with your number, your hours and your address where people look for them, and a way for someone to contact you that actually reaches you.

You own it outright. The domain, the hosting and every account are created in your business's name from the first day, with me added as a helper. Nothing lives in my accounts.

Straight with you. That ownership point is the one I would check with anyone you hire, not just me. If a website person holds your domain in their own account, leaving them is expensive and awkward. With me you can walk away whenever you like and take everything, and you do not have to ask me for permission to do it.

Your Google listing

The panel that appears when somebody searches your name, or searches for what you sell with the word "near me" on the end.

Getting it created, getting it verified, and filling it out the way Google actually wants it filled out. Category, service areas, hours, services, photos, and the website link pointed at the page that answers what that person came for.

What it takes from you. It has to be created under your own Google login and Google verifies it against you personally, so we do that part together at your computer. Verification can take a few days before anything shows publicly.

Reviews. The best time to ask a customer for one is the day you finish their job, and almost nobody does. I will set you up to ask.

Straight with you. There are several ways to get a listing suspended, and a suspended listing is slow and painful to get back. Putting a mailbox address in the location field is one. Stuffing keywords into the business name is another, and competitors report it. I know which ones to stay away from because I read the rules properly before I set up mine.

A phone that answers when you cannot

Most people who call a small business and get voicemail do not leave one. They hang up and call the next name on the list, and you never find out.

So when a call comes in and nobody picks up, the caller gets a text from your business within seconds. They reply to it, that reply lands on your phone, and you answer when you get a minute. It is not a chatbot and nobody is pretending to be you. It is one automatic first text that holds the door open.

A new business number. For anyone still running the business off a personal cell. A real local number that belongs to the business, while your cell stays yours.

Keep the number you have. Your existing line forwards over only when nobody answers, so nothing changes for the people calling you. The text-back reaches them from the service number rather than the one they dialled.

Move your number across. Calls and texts both live on your number and the customer sees one number throughout. Cleanest for them, longest to arrange.

Straight with you. Every US business sending automated texts has to be registered with the phone carriers first, and I do that paperwork. Mine took twelve days and two rejections before it cleared, so plan on a wait rather than a same-day start. That wait is the reason this is worth paying someone for.

How the work actually gets done

One person, and I would rather be straight about the method than have you wonder. I build with AI, working alongside Claude, the same way an editor works with the machine in front of them. I am not a career software developer and I am not going to pretend to be one. What that buys you is speed, and a price a one-person shop can actually charge.

What keeps it honest is that none of it counts as finished until it is tested in the real world. My phone system was not done when it was built. It was done when somebody called it, let it ring out, got the text, and texted back, and I watched the whole thing happen.

What I will need from you

Not much, but the pieces I do need cannot come from anyone else, so it is worth knowing before we start.

For a video. A few hours at your place at a time that suits you, and you willing to be on camera answering questions. That is the whole ask.

For the website. Half an hour telling me what you actually do and who walks through the door, and a decision on the name if you are buying a domain.

For the Google listing. Time at your computer with me, since it has to be created under your own login and Google verifies it against you.

For the phone. Your greeting and the wording of the first text, in your words, and a few days of patience while the carriers approve it.

Where to start

Twenty minutes on the phone. Tell me what is most broken right now and I will tell you which one of these fixes it, and which ones you can leave alone for a year. If it is not a fit I will say so on that call rather than send you a quote.

We do not do all four at once. One at a time, finished and working, then the next.